

Thursday September 17th – morning

09.00 – 09.30

Reception

09.30 – 09.50

PLENARY Conference Opening - A Espinosa, J Walker, A Fattoum

09.50 – 10:00

Stafford Beer - a truly holistic character (A Leonard, V Beer)

10:20 – 10:30

Launching 100 Years Festschrift: A Espinosa, M Schwaninger, J.P. Rios

10.30 - 11:00

Coffee

Room A

Resilient and Ethical
Viable Systems

Room B

Emerging Methods and
Tools

Room C

Stafford Beer in Latin
America

Room D

Barefoot Cybernetics

11.00 - 11:45

Angela Espinosa
Managing Organisational
and Societal Complexity
for a Fairer and More
Sustainable New World

Markus Schwaninger
CyberSystemic Tools for
Organizational
Advancement.

Víctor Ganón
From Organisation to
State: Adapting,
Reinterpreting and
Challenging Stafford
Beer's Cybernetic Ideas
in Public Administration
and Democratic
Governance — The Case
of URUCIB in Uruguay

Clive Holtham
Learning an outlook –
Beer's neglected
contribution to
reshaping higher
education in an AI-
infused world

11:45 - 12:15

Allenna Leonard
Twenty One Years of
Beer

Martin Pfiffner
From Theory to Practice
– and Back

Juliana Mariano-Alves
Transparency as a
Trigger for Change:
Repercussions of the
Viable System Model
(VSM) Application on
Water Governance in the
Tocantins-Araguaia
Hydrographic Region

Stephen Harwood
Cybernetics For All
(#Cybernetics4All)

12:15 - 13:00

Constantin Malik
Designing Freedom.
Still. And again

Vijaya Manchem
Translating VSM into
Practice: A
Capability-Led Approach
using Microsoft 365

John Byrne
Useful Art as a Toolkit
for Cybernetic Change:
A Viable Systems Model
for a Better World Today

Marc-André Pigeon
Beer's Pedagogy:
Lessons from the
Concordia University
Lectures

13.00 - 14.00

Lunch

Thursday September 17th – afternoon

Room A
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Viable Systems

Room B
Emerging Methods and
Tools

Room C
Stafford Beer in Latin
America

Room D
Barefoot Cybernetics

13.00 - 14.00

Lunch

14.00 - 14:45

Angus Jenkinson
Ecocybernetics and the
Living Foundations of
Beer's Viable System
Model

Stephen McGibbon
Embracing the Black
Box: Why Unexplainable
AI (x"AI") is a Vital
Feature of the Viable
System's Algedonic
Channel

**Mateus Van Stralen,
Juliana Alves, Jose
Dos Santos Cabral,
Allenna Leonard**
From Confluence to
Emergence: What Ouro
Preto Made Possible ASC
2026 – Reflections,
Outcomes and New
Pathways

Franz Spengler
How do viable systems
emerge? Algedonic
origins in the case of
Swedish collective
bargaining

14:45-15:30

**Steve Outtrim & David
J. Teece**
Beer-Viable but Teece-
Dead: The Viable
System Model as the
Wiring Diagram of
Dynamic Capabilities

Andreas Slogar
"The Journey of LaCoCa
- A Crew Sets Sail!" -
Gamification Makes the
VSM an Experience - No
Theory Required
(workshop)

Bruno Vaz
Viable Space
Governance in Latin
America: A Processual
Reading through Beer's
VSM

**Thomas A.J.
Biedermann**
Gameful Experiences for
Hopeful Futures:
CyberNations
(workshop)

15.30 - 16.00

Coffee

16.00 - 16:30

**Katharine N. Farrell,
Jon Walker, Ed van
der Winden &
(posthumously) Brian
Lederer**
Don't shoot the cat
(workshop)

Ayham Fattoum
When Viable Systems
Fail: Explaining the Gap
Between Diagnosis and
Practice (workshop)

**Zeltzin Pérez-
Matamoros, Ricardo
Tejeida-Padilla &
Isaías Badillo-Piña**
Governance in the
Magdalena River
Community from the
Postulates of the Viable
System Model
(workshop)

Tom Chan
'Se hace camino al
andar': barefoot
cybernetic pathmaking
to Stafford Beer

16:30-17:00

Miguel Garcia Matas
Design of a Cybernetic
Governance Framework
for Platform Tokenomics

17.00 - 17.45

Michael Ben Eli
(keynote)
Systems Thinking and
Cybernetics -- the
Missing Link in the
Sustainability Discourse

Wolfgang Lassi
From Values to
Organizational Practice -
the Contribution of the
VSM to value-oriented
leadership in the age of
digitalization

**H. Palmarola, E.
Medina & P.L. Alonso**
Video about the
Cybersyn Exhibition
(edited by S Paredes)

*Closure of Latin
American Stream:*
Jose C Mariategui
Governance and the
Politics of Possibility

**José dos Santos
Cabral Filho & Ana
Paula Baltazar dos
Santos**
Architecture for
Freedom: Syntegrity as
an Educational Practice

Friday September 18th

Room A
The World in Torment

Room B
VSM & AI

Room C
Barefoot Cybernetics

Room D
Innovations in VSM
Theory

09.00 – 09.45

Francesco Caputo
Building upon the Project Cybersyn: CyberSystemic Management for blending Structural Cybernetics and Relational Consonance (keynote)

José Pérez Ríos
A Cybernetic Architecture for AI Governance: Integrating Identity, VSM, and Organizational Pathologies

Jon Walker
Towards new economic and social structures for a collaborative, post-capitalistic society

Tadeja Jere Jakulin
The Škofja Loka Passion Play as a Nexus of System, Culture, Art and Religion

09.45 – 10.30

German Bula Escobar
Beer's Thought in the Colombian Comptroller General Project: Beyond Detecting Corruption—Designing Viable Public Institutions through Organizational Cybernetics (keynote)

Pedram Farschtschian & Louis Harel
Bridging PIMS Data and Cybernetics: An Externally Anchored Operations Room

Theodor Sarafidis
Artificial intelligence as a liberty machine. A metamodelization of barefoot cybernetics

Richard Gunther
From Evidence to Inquiry: Keeping LLM Inference Provisional in Recursive VSM Diagnosis

10.30 – 11.00

Coffee

11.00 – 11.45

Raul Espejo
Insufficient Variety and Artificial Intelligence

Ricardo Vega Mora
Cybersyn Boxes. Prototyping a Document Visualisation Assisted by AI

Lien Peeters & Benny Corvers
Rethinking Organisational Networks: Practical Insights from Applying the Viable System Model in Real World Ecosystems

Pedro Pablo Cardoso
Designing Viable Identity in Institutional Transitions: A VSM Reconstruction of the Total Veteran Framework

11.45 – 12.30

Igor Perko
CyberSystemic Model Creation Protocol: AI-energy-climate-health governance case

Alejandro Fernandez
OpenSoma: A Decolonial Cybernetic Agent A Working System in the Line of Descent from Project Cybersyn

Thomas McEvoy-Zafropulos
Diagnosing the System of the Self: Logical Closure, Normative Identity, and Existential Viability

Nour Abida
Can Stafford Beer Help Save Journalism? Applying the Viable System Model to Understand Resilience in Public Service Media

12:30 – 13:30

Lunch

Friday September 18th – afternoon/evening

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Theory

12:30 – 13:30 **Lunch**

13.30 – 14:00

Plenary - WOSC "The World in Torment: A Time Whose Ideas Must Come" I Perko, F Caputo, A Reyes

14:00 - 14.30

Taja Macek & Tadeja Jere Jakulin
Toward viability: applying the Viable System Model to the cruise shorescape

Steve Outtrim & David J. Teece
The Next 100 Years of Stafford Beer: A Working Viable System Model for the Agentic AI Era

Mateus van Stralen
From Cybersyn to the City: Variety Engineering and the Design of Open Urban Infrastructures

Krishan Mathis
The Speed Gap - Translating the Viable System Model for a New Generation of Practitioners

14.30 - 15:00

Cristina Cervino & Francesco Caputo, Igor Perko
Taming the Digital Beast: Variety Engineering and the Quest for Techno-Eustress

Katherine Farrell
Purposive AI for the 21st Century Sustainable University

Andrew Pickering
Ponds, politics and the east: Stafford Beer's cybernetics - a wider view (Keynote)

Terence Love
Viable for Whom? Contested Identity in the VSM

14.45

15:00 - 15:30

Fabiana Sepe & Simone Luongo, Giovanna Del Gaudio, Mario Tani, Gianpaolo Basile
Toward resilient and ethical viable tourism systems: a cybernetic view on marginal areas digital transformation in Italy

15:30 - 16:00

Coffee

16:00 - 16:30

Maria Giovanna Corrado
Organizational Cybernetics in the Age of AI: Toward an Epistemic Conception of Viability

Krishan Mathis, Margeret Heath, Panos Panagiotis
Cybernetic Futures (workshop)

Robin Asby & Penny Marrington
Cybernetics of Community Development – A TEAM (Thinking with Every Available Mind) Activity (workshop)

Jonathan Huxley
A full software implementation of Stafford Beer's Viable System Model (VSM) as a complete enterprise management system (workshop)

16:30 - 17:00

Maurizio Tomasella
Charting the Boundaries of Accountability for Enhanced Airport Operational Resilience

17:05 - 18:30

Video Documentary Screening - Digital Museum B Angelov, A Espinosa, J Walker, V Beer, A Leonard, G Filewod, B Vaz

20.00 - 23.00

Celebratory Dinner (buffet) and Toast to Stafford Beer

Saturday September 19th

	Room A Systems Thinking, Systems Practice (VSM, CST, etc.)	Room B Innovations in VSM theory	Room C Toward Resilient, and Ethical Viable Systems	Room D Innovations in VSM Practice
09.00 – 09.15	Reception			
09.15 - 10.00	Mike Jackson Elevating Stafford Beer's Legacy: A Critical Systems Thinking Perspective on the Viable System Model (keynote)	Jan de Visch The Art of Boundary- Making: Deepening the VSM through Cognitive- Developmental Science	Amar KJR Nayak From Organizational Viability to Regenerativeness - A methodological discourse	Carola Ritzinger-Roll From viability to measurability – Designing governance structures in highly complex and regulated organisational contexts
10.00 - 10.45	Gary Evans, Petter Øgland & Jens Kaasbøll Reclaiming Emancipation in Critical Systems Thinking: Using the Double Viable System Model to Identify the Central Game	Steve Brewis Languaging an Adaptive Organisation into Existence: from Surprise to Causal Closure	Leon Bellin The Social Movement of Tomorrow: Sharing Practical VSM Application (workshop)	Ben Wood Designing Heterarchy: An Extension of the Viable System Model for Complex Construction Projects.
10.45 - 11.15	Coffee			
11.15 - 12.00	Roelien Goede & Gary Smith Foundations in Dialogue: Comparing VSM and CSH through Checkland's FMA Framework	Ivo Velitchkov Autonomy and cohesion	Sascha Kullak HEX-VSM — an idea for a serious game: "How do we shape our organisations so that they heal us more than they harm us?"	Camilo Osejo Bucheli Temporal Freedom in Viable Systems: A Genealogical Analysis of Human and Machine Time in Organisational Cybernetics
12:00-12:45	Louis Klein (IFSR) (keynote) Diagnosing the System for Systems Research: Recognising and Realising a Field in Itself and for Itself	Marcus Barrick Enactive Viable Agency: A Process Relational Grammar for Meta- Cybernetics and the VSM	Chris Hamlin, Penny Hamlin & Frank Hemmes From Building a Regime to Running It: A Participatory Viable System Model Diagnostic of a Regulator Entering Dual- Mode Operation	Carlos Andrés Mejía Beltrán Exchange Ecologies and Existential Conductivity: A Cybernetic Framework for Hybrid Human Systems
12:45 - 13.45	Lunch			
14.00 – 14:15	Final session - Introduction			
14:15 – 16:15	Closing session: Pathways forward			
16:15 – 16.30	Closing Remarks & Farewell (Conference Team)			